Health Coverage Meeting

For JN Enterprises' pastor · Prepared by Eric Barayuga, licensed health insurance agent
HelpingHawaiiSeniors.com

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DATE	PLACE	TIME	KEY DEADLINE
Fri, Nov 13, 2026	Manila Optical, Waipahu	~30–40 min	Dec 15 → coverage Jan 1

Goal: find the best health coverage he can get in 2027. As a green card holder one year in Hawaii, he can't get Med-QUEST yet (five-year wait). His choices depend on **his income** and **how the church pays him**.

1 Status and documents

5 min

- [ ] Green card: "Resident since" date on the card: _____ (starts his five-year clock for Med-QUEST)
- [ ] Date he entered the U.S.: _____
- [ ] Social Security number: has one / applied / not yet. If not yet, he should apply at SSA; he can still enroll in the Marketplace with his green card number.
- [ ] Date of birth / age: _____ Married? Spouse or children here? Household size: _____
- [ ] Any coverage now (travel insurance, church plan, anything from the Philippines)?

2 Income and how the church pays him

10 min

- [ ] Church pay: $_____ per **week / month** (the "$300" — which one?)
- [ ] Paid through payroll (W-2), or as a gift / honorarium / allowance?
- [ ] Hours per week for the church: _____
- [ ] Housing: lives at the church. Is it given as part of his pay (parsonage / housing allowance)?
- [ ] Other income in 2027: wedding or funeral fees, love gifts, other jobs, money from the Philippines: _____
- [ ] Has he filed **Form 4361** (minister's opt-out of Social Security)? Does he pay self-employment tax?
- [ ] Expected **total 2027 income**: $_____ (this number decides the subsidy)

3 Health

5 min

- [ ] Doctors he sees now or wants to keep; regular prescriptions: _____
- [ ] Polio history: is the leg weakness changing? New weakness, fatigue or pain? (post-polio syndrome: worth a doctor visit and records)
- [ ] Did he pay into Philippine **SSS**? He may be able to claim SSS disability benefits from Hawaii.

4 Which option fits

10 min

If...	Then	Next step
The church employs him **20+ hrs/week** for 4 weeks in a row and pays at least **~$1,387/month**	Hawaii's Prepaid Health Care Act: the **church must offer him a plan**.	Talk to the church about a group plan. Usually best for him.
Income is **at or above ~$15,650/yr** (single; higher line for a bigger household)	**Marketplace plan with a subsidy** (green card holders keep subsidy eligibility in 2027).	Enroll on HealthCare.gov by Dec 15. Eric can enroll him as his agent.
Income is **below** the poverty line (e.g., $300/month)	No Med-QUEST yet and **no subsidy**: full-price plan only.	Ask the church to pay his premium or raise his pay above the line; use a community health center meanwhile.
Uninsured or can't afford a plan	Community health centers see patients regardless of insurance, sliding-scale fees.	Find the nearest center (link below).
In about 5 years (≈ 2030)	Five-year wait ends: **Med-QUEST** if income qualifies.	Set a reminder for the date on his green card.

Not available now: SSI and SSDI disability. SSI needs 10 years of U.S. work and five years as a resident; SSDI needs U.S. work credits he doesn't have yet. Med-QUEST also has the five-year wait, disabled or not.

5 Enrollment links

What	Link
Marketplace: apply & enroll	**HealthCare.gov — Apply & enroll** `healthcare.gov/apply-and-enroll`
Preview plans & prices (no account)	**HealthCare.gov — See plans** `healthcare.gov/see-plans`
Coverage rules for immigrants	**HealthCare.gov — Immigrants** `healthcare.gov/immigrants`
Med-QUEST (for later, or to check)	**Med-QUEST online portal** · phone 1-800-316-8005 `medical.mybenefits.hawaii.gov`
Social Security number	**SSA — Get a Social Security card** `ssa.gov/number-card`
Community health centers	**Find a Health Center (HRSA)** `findahealthcenter.hrsa.gov`
Church as employer (Hawaii law)	**Hawaii DLIR — Prepaid Health Care Act** `labor.hawaii.gov/dcd`
Minister pay & GET	**Hawaii Tax Facts 2019-2: Churches & Ministers** · 808-587-4242 `Church pay and housing allowance are not subject to GET`
Philippine SSS disability	**Social Security System (Philippines)** `sss.gov.ph`

6 Key dates for 2027 coverage

Date	What happens
Now – Dec 15, 2026	Pick a plan on HealthCare.gov → coverage starts **Jan 1, 2027**
Dec 16 – Jan 15, 2027	Late enrollment → coverage starts Feb 1, 2027 (confirm the closing date on HealthCare.gov)
Any time	Community health centers; SSN application

7 What to bring to enroll

- ☐ Green card (number and "Resident since" date)
- ☐ SSN, if he has one
- ☐ Date of birth; household members' info
- ☐ Proof of income: church pay records, letter from the church
- ☐ Mailing address (the church) and phone / email
- ☐ List of doctors and medicines

8 Next steps and notes

- ☐ Eric: confirm income estimate and household size → run plan prices
- ☐ Church / JN owner: decide on covering his premium or moving his pay to payroll
- ☐ Pastor: apply for SSN if needed; book a doctor visit about the leg
- ☐ Follow-up date: _____ (before **Dec 15**)

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Figures: 2026 federal poverty line for one person ($15,650) and Hawaii minimum wage ($16/hr; Prepaid Health Care threshold = 86.67 × minimum wage ≈ $1,387/month). General information for planning, not legal or tax advice. Confirm eligibility on HealthCare.gov or with Med-QUEST.